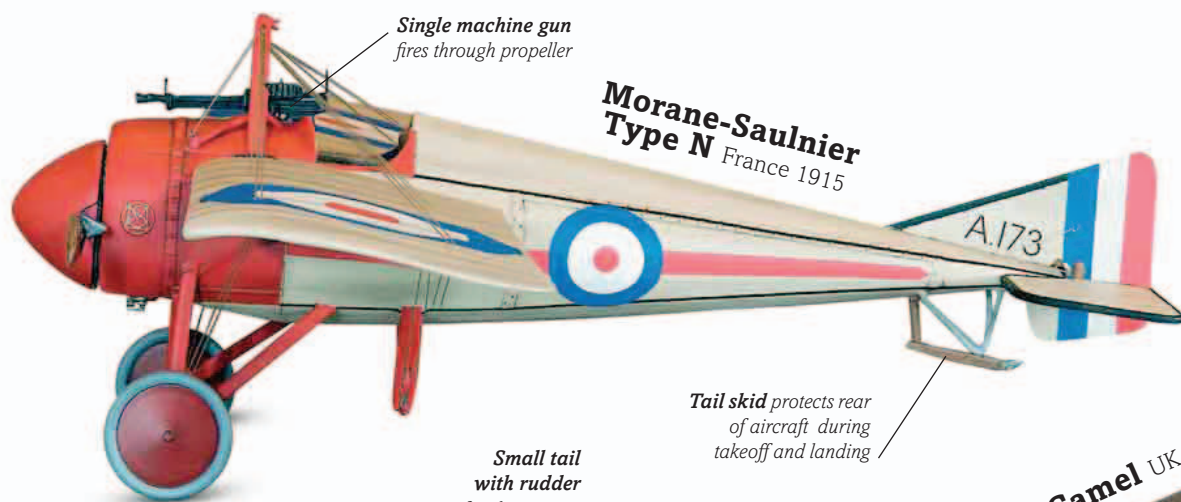




Fighter planes



Single machine gun
fires through propeller

**Morane-Saulnier
Type N** France 1915

Tail skid protects rear
of aircraft during
takeoff and landing

Small tail
with rudder
for sharp turns

SPAD SVII France 1916



Sopwith F.1 Camel UK 1917

Twin engines give a long
range of 1,300 miles (2,100 km)



Wingspan of 30ft
(9m) helps aircraft
to climb up

Fokker D.VII Germany 1918

Manfred
Von Richthofen's
Dr.1 was painted
all red, giving him
the nickname of
the **Red
Baron**.

Fokker Dr.1
Germany 1917

Three sets of short wings enable
sharper climbing and turning



Fast and maneuverable, fighter planes were an air force's hunter-killers during World Wars I and II. Their forward-firing weapons, such as cannons and machine guns, were mounted on the nose or the wings to shoot down other aircraft.

Early World War I fighters, such as the **Morane-Saulnier Type N**, preyed on slow, often unarmed, bombers and reconnaissance aircraft. They were soon outpaced by faster fliers, such as the **Sopwith Camel** and **Fokker D.VII**, which engaged in furious dogfights against each other.